01 / THE COMPLETE FIELD GUIDE

BEFORE YOU RENOVATE. BEFORE YOU SELL.

A practical preparation guide for Gold Coast and Brisbane homeowners.

The reel asks you to pause before spending. This guide helps you decide what to do next: understand the buyer, check the condition, compare the full cost, then choose the smallest sensible scope.



Broadbeach property photography from a campaign marketed by Cyril. This is a presentation example, not proof of a renovation return.

What you will leave with

A room-by-room starting point, four questions to test a quote, a realistic budget example and a checklist to use at your own home. You do not need to renovate every room to prepare for a sale.

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English and French. Gold Coast and Brisbane.

Reviewed 26 October 2026. General guidance only. Suitability, costs and likely sale outcomes depend on your property. A market appraisal is not a formal valuation. Sources and evidence limits are on page 8.

02 / BEFORE THE FIRST QUOTE

FOUR QUESTIONS. THEN A DECISION.

1. What problem are you actually solving?

Separate a defect from a dated finish. A leaking shower needs diagnosis; an older but functioning shower may only need cleaning. Replacing a vanity does not establish that a waterproofing problem has been repaired.

2. Is there a cheaper way to solve it?

Test the least invasive option first: clean before replacing, adjust before rebuilding, touch up before repainting every room. Get advice before disturbing older materials or making electrical, structural or wet-area changes.

3. What shows that your buyer values the change?

Ask your agent for several recent settled sales of genuinely similar homes, including homes in different conditions. Compare dwelling type, land, size, parking, outlook, street and sale date. A nearby renovated home selling for more does not isolate the value of its renovation.

4. Does the full cost still make sense in a downside case?

Include labour, materials, preparation, demolition, disposal, professional fees, approvals, contingency and any delay to sale. Ask what happens if the improvement adds less than expected, or nothing. Keep essential safety and compliance decisions separate from a profit calculation.

CALL	HOW TO USE IT
Spend	Consider modest preparation that solves a visible problem within your budget. Not an instruction to spend regardless of condition.
Fix	Investigate a defect or compliance issue and agree an appropriate remedy with a qualified professional.
Ask first	Pause for condition, cost, buyer and timing advice before committing.
Skip for now	Defer discretionary work unless property-specific evidence and the full costs support it.

Basis: industry guidance [1], budget planning [2] and inspection guidance [3]. The four-call framework is this guide’s practical decision aid, not a validated return model.

03 / ROOM BY ROOM

START WITH CONDITION. NOT A SHOPPING LIST.

AREA	START HERE	BEFORE SPENDING MORE
Entry and garden	Clear access, mow, edge and prune modestly. Repair an unsafe gate.	Ask whether new landscaping changes the buyer decision enough to justify its cost. Avoid a garden that needs ongoing maintenance during the campaign.
Living areas	Declutter, clean glass and check existing lights. Make room use clear.	Do not repaint sound, clean walls automatically. Compare targeted touch-ups with a full repaint; test finish and colour match.
Kitchen	Clean thoroughly. Repair a faulty hinge or leaking tap with the right trade.	A functioning dated kitchen may be sufficient. A full replacement belongs in Ask first: assess layout, condition, local buyer expectations and quotes.
Bathroom	Clean and inspect. Look for persistent damp, swelling or loose tiles.	Get the cause of water damage assessed. Fresh grout or silicone is not evidence that concealed waterproofing is sound.
Floors	Try a suitable professional clean where appropriate. Remove trip hazards.	Compare repair, partial replacement and full replacement. Ask whether patching will look worse than leaving a consistent older finish.
Outside surfaces	Identify the material and use an appropriate cleaning method.	Never pressure-wash suspected asbestos. Ask a specialist before cleaning, sanding or disturbing unknown older materials.

Big projects are not automatically wrong

A new kitchen, bathroom, deck or extension can be appropriate in some circumstances. It is not a default pre-sale task. Confirm the buyer case, approvals, trade availability, complete scope and downside before starting.

These are practical starting points, not guaranteed sale-price effects. See industry guidance [1], inspections [3] and asbestos restrictions [4].

04 / REPAIRS AND QUEENSLAND REQUIREMENTS

MAKE IT SOUND.
THEN MAKE IT PRESENTABLE.

Do not paint over the question

Water stains, timber deterioration, movement and recurring mould deserve investigation before cosmetic work. Ask what caused the issue, what repair is proposed and what documentation will be available. Use appropriately qualified and licensed professionals. A pre-sale check does not replace a buyer’s own inspection. [3]

Know the material before you disturb it

High-pressure water cleaning of asbestos-containing materials is prohibited. Do not assume an older roof, fence or wall is safe to blast, sand or drill. Get advice from a suitably qualified asbestos professional if the material is uncertain. [4]

Smoke alarms

Check compliant interconnected photoelectric alarms, including bedroom, hallway and storey locations. The requirements extend to all existing private homes from 1 January 2027; requirements already apply to homes being sold. Have an appropriate installer confirm the setup for your dwelling. [5]

Pools and spas

Confirm the certificate or prescribed notice process early. For a non-shared pool sold without a certificate, the buyer generally has 90 days after settlement to obtain one. Shared pools involve different responsibilities. Ask your solicitor and licensed pool safety inspector which steps and deadlines apply. [6]

Seller disclosure

Since 1 August 2025, Queensland’s seller disclosure scheme generally requires Form 2 and prescribed certificates before the buyer signs, subject to exceptions. Engage your solicitor early. Form 2 is not a building inspection or a warranty of structural condition. Ask separately about other disclosure and contractual obligations. [7]

Keep a simple property file

Keep reports, quotes, repair invoices, warranties, certificates and approval information together. Record unresolved items and discuss how to deal with them with your sale team. Do not describe a cosmetic refresh as a remedy for a defect.

05 / SCOPE AND TIMING

A WRITTEN SCOPE. A REALISTIC FINISH DATE.

Compare like with like

Ask each trade to quote the same scope. Check preparation, material specification, labour, inclusions, exclusions, disposal, access, cleanup, tax and who handles approvals. Confirm licence and insurance requirements for the work. A cheaper quote with missing preparation is not the same job.

Set the decision before the deadline

Work backwards from photography, leaving time for drying, curing, rectification and cleaning. Do not book a major renovation merely because a trade can start tomorrow. Confirm when the home will be inspection-ready, not just when the trade leaves.

WHEN	PRIORITY	CHECK BEFORE MOVING ON
About 6 weeks out	Walk through, investigate concerns, get quotes and start sale documents.	Agree what is essential, what is optional and the maximum scope.
About 5-4 weeks out	Complete agreed repairs and compliance work.	Resolve causes before cosmetic finishes; keep records.
About 3 weeks out	Targeted finishes and garden preparation.	Choose work suited to the actual condition and available time.
About 2 weeks out	Pack, clean, style and check lighting.	Avoid new projects that could push back photography.
Final week	Photographs, floorplan and sale-readiness check.	Check documents and marketing descriptions with your sale team.

This is an example sequence, not a promise that every home can be prepared in six weeks. Diagnosis, approvals, trade access and drying times can take longer.

A useful stopping rule

If the scope keeps growing, the buyer case is unclear or the completion date is uncertain, pause. Compare selling with the current condition properly explained against completing the project. Discuss the alternatives before authorising more work.

Budget approach informed by [2]. Scope, sequence and stopping rule are practical recommendations from this guide.

06 / A WORKED DECISION

MORE SALE PRICE IS NOT ALWAYS MORE MONEY.

For an optional project, compare the possible extra sale proceeds with **every incremental cost**. Do not use this test to avoid necessary safety or legal requirements.

Hypothetical example - not a prediction

Assume a cosmetic package is quoted at $12,000, you reserve $2,000 for uncertainty, and the work creates $1,000 of additional holding or delay costs. The total comparison is $15,000. These figures are invented to show the calculation; they are not local quotes or expected returns.

ASSUMED EXTRA SALE PROCEEDS	TOTAL EXTRA COST	NET DIFFERENCE
$20,000	$15,000	+$5,000
$10,000	$15,000	-$5,000
$0	$15,000	-$15,000

Decision equation:
Additional sale proceeds minus works, contingency and additional holding/transaction costs = possible net benefit.

Before accepting the optimistic case

• Ask what local evidence supports the assumed extra proceeds. A suburb median or an online asking price is not proof of renovation uplift.

• Check whether the comparison homes differ in land, size, view, floorplan, parking or sale date. Those differences may explain the price gap.

• Ask for a range and the assumptions behind it. Treat an agent’s appraisal as an opinion, not a guarantee of what a renovation will return.

• Include costs that change because of the work. If finance, tax or your circumstances matter, get advice from the relevant professional.

The better question

Not “Will buyers like it?” but “Is this the most sensible use of money and time for this home, before this sale?” Sometimes the answer is a smaller scope, or no optional work.

Budget completeness and contingency concept: [2]. Numerical scenarios and equation are illustrative decision tools, not research findings or financial advice.

07 / YOUR WORKING CHECKLIST

TAKE THIS AROUND YOUR OWN HOME.

[ ] I have written down my likely selling timeframe and photography target.

[ ] I have separated safety/compliance concerns from cosmetic preferences.

[ ] I have listed the jobs I am considering and the problem each one solves.

[ ] I have checked whether cleaning, adjustment or repair could be sufficient.

[ ] I have asked for relevant recent settled sales, not only asking prices.

[ ] I have compared quotes for the same scope, including exclusions and cleanup.

[ ] I have allowed for contingency and any delay or additional holding costs.

[ ] I have considered a lower-benefit or no-benefit outcome for optional works.

[ ] I have started the Queensland compliance and disclosure conversations.

[ ] I have recorded what I will do, what I will defer and who I need to consult.

My next three decisions

JOB / QUESTION	NEXT ACTION	WHO / BY WHEN

Use the interactive planner on the website for a personalised PDF. You can also include those selected jobs when requesting a walkthrough, so Team Cyril receives your actual shortlist.

Open the planner and request a free pre-sale walkthrough + appraisal

Your checklist is a starting point. The appropriate scope depends on an assessment of your property, your circumstances and current local evidence.

08 / EVIDENCE AND NEXT STEPS

WHAT SUPPORTS THIS GUIDE?

There is no universal percentage return for paint, kitchens or bathrooms in this guide. The linked sources support specific planning, inspection and compliance points. They do not prove that a particular renovation will increase your sale price.

[1] REIWA - How to maximise your selling price

Industry guidance: minor preparation and the risk of overcapitalising. Not a Queensland price study or a guaranteed uplift.

[2] Australian Government Your Home - Preliminary research

Planning a total budget, including contingencies and less obvious costs. Not evidence of a resale premium.

[3] Queensland Government - Property inspections

Condition assessment and appropriately licensed building, pest and other inspectors.

[4] Queensland Government Asbestos - Prohibited activities

High-pressure cleaning of asbestos-containing materials is prohibited.

[5] Queensland Fire Department - Smoke alarms

Current alarm types, locations and the 1 January 2027 deadline.

[6] OBCC - Buy, sell or lease a property with a pool

Certificate and notice requirements; shared and non-shared pools differ.

[7] Queensland Government - Seller disclosure scheme

Form 2, prescribed documents, timing and exceptions.

What to ask Cyril at the walkthrough

Which buyers are most relevant to this home? Which recent settled sales support the appraisal? What differences explain their prices? Which three jobs would you prioritise, which would you leave, and why? What would selling without the optional work look like?

Free pre-sale walkthrough and market appraisal
Cyril Texier / NGU Real Estate
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Request a time on the website

No obligation to list. A market appraisal is an estimate for marketing purposes, not a formal valuation. General information only; seek qualified building, legal, tax or financial advice when relevant. Sources reviewed 26 October 2026. Check current requirements before acting.

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